MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 4-15-2026

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
March 18, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the agenda as amended, **Motion carried.**

*Addition: XII. A – Clerk's Report

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners' Minutes of February 18, 2026, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Multiple county residents voiced support for the Board of Commissioners to vote to display America's National Motto "In God We Trust".

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Resolution in support of Repealing MCL 46.615 (2) – Wexford County – No Discussion
2. Notification of updating Master Plan – Surrey Township – No Discussion
3. Medical Examiner Report for February 2026 – No Discussion
4. MMR Report through February 2026 – No Discussion

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Lisa Kaspriak – Clare County Medical Examiner's Office
   The Administrator of the Clare County Medical Examiner's Office, Lisa Kaspriak, provided the Board of Commissioners with the annual report. She shared that the number of cases in Fiscal Year (FY) 2025 compared to the previous year increased. Additionally, she expressed gratitude for the staff at the Medical Examiner's Office.

   Lisa Kaspriak reported that Clare County recently had its first resident use the brand new Computed Tomography (CT) scanner. The CT scanner is a non-invasive tool used in the Medical Examiner's Office, in addition to toxicology and autopsies.

JUSTICE

1. Medical Examiner
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to renew the contract with Mid Michigan Medical Examiner Group LLC as presented through September 30, 2029, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Sheriff Services
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the contract renewal with Lincoln Township for the provision of additional law enforcement protection and services, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Emergency Management – Homeland Security
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the annual grant agreement between the Michigan State Police and Clare County in the amount of $6,250.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

1. Veterans Freedom Park
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the sublease of the Veterans Freedom Park between Clare County and The Veterans Freedom Park of Clare County, a Michigan non-profit corporation for $1.00 per year through December 21, 2032, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Housler, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gross and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Drain – Dodge Lake Project Loan
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve an internal loan for the Dodge Lake project not to exceed $155,000.00 at 1.5% interest for a term of two years payable through the Dodge Lake Level Special Assessment, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon, Ambrozaitis, Haskell, Hoefling and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - continued

2. Drain – Lake Level Resolution
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve Resolution #26-06 Eight Point Lake, Lake Level Resolution Pursuant to MCL 324.30701 for maintenance and improvements expected to exceed $10,000.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of February 17, 2026 in the amount of $163,115.96 and the meeting minutes of March 2, 2026 in the amount of $192,321.45, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Haskell, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve the expenditures for the month of February 2026, in the amount of $1,533,767.56 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $512,308.29, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments - None

4. Policy and Procedures – Michigan Indigent Defense Commission (MIDC) Invoice
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the Michigan Indigent Defense Fund Program Assigned Counsel Invoice Submission Policy as presented, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Gilmore, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

5. State and Local Cybersecurity Grant Program (SLCGP) Grant
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the State and Local Cybersecurity Grant in the amount of $222,060.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gross, Majewski, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Housler, Kleinhardt, Gilmore and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

6. Intergovernmental Agreement
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Intergovernmental Agreement between Clare County and the Clare County Road Commission that more clearly defines the payment obligation for the Bond issue, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT-

Administrator Lori Phelps reported that State budgets and County funding proposals are moving forward with suggestions of no increase for County revenue sharing. She also shared updates regarding a few house bills in the works.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott informed the Board of Commissioners that she is working with a couple of State and Nationwide work groups to combat ransomware, malware and eliminate the risk of property fraud. As far as elections, Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott reported that there will not be a May 2026 election. The Bureau of Elections has not made a commitment to fund new election equipment and there is not a requirement yet to purchase new equipment. Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott plans to include replacement of election equipment in the 2027 budget in case the State requires new equipment and does not provide funding.

Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott further reported that legislation is in the works to change the primary election from August to May. If the change is approved it will not go into effect until 2027 and the result will be having elections in February, May and November. She listed the partial and full term positions throughout Clare County that will be on the upcoming August Election ballot.

Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott shared several issues with the United States Postal Service in regard to late mail and a recent change with how incoming mail is postmarked. Unfortunately, the change will effect military and overseas voters because we rely on postmarked dates to process ballots that are received after the election. Lastly, she explained that her office will now be comparing incoming jury questionnaires to their Qualified Voter File to ensure that any resident that states they are not qualified to sit on a jury because they are not a United States citizen are not registered to vote.

After a question from a Commissioner regarding property fraud, Clerk & Register of Deeds Mott explained that there is a nationwide problem with property fraud with the most common form of property fraud crimes being committed among family members. The Register of Deeds office offers a free Property Fraud Alert service. Clare County residents can visit the Register of Deeds website, call or stop into the office to sign up for the free service. She recommended signing up individual names, business names and trusts.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the current statutory reports to the Commissioners. She stated that post office issues are also a concern in her office citing a few examples. The Rabies Clinic at the Clare County Animal Shelter was a success working an hour past the scheduled end time and selling 118 dog licenses.

The Treasurer's office is busy with two of the three tax deadlines wrapped up. They are also preparing to send 1,086 forfeiture certificates for the 2024 tax year to the Register of Deeds Office for recording. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger gave an update on the 2025 tax year and the disbursement goal of April 2026. Lastly, she encouraged the Commissioners to send residents with 2023 delinquent taxes to her office to avoid tax foreclosure.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore reported an issue with Grant Township's assessor and overdue assessments.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had nothing to report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis had nothing to report.

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings but had nothing to report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt stated that his Northern Michigan Counties (MAC) meeting was recently canceled due to weather.

Commissioner Haskell reported that a resident called him who has had issues with her address for several years. Recently her husband had a medical emergency and the ambulance had a difficult time locating their residence. Commissioner Haskell reached out to Administrator Phelps and she informed him that Clare County has a Public Safety Addressing Committee. The newly formed Committee is comprised of the Administration office, Clare County Road Commission, Central Dispatch - 911, the Building Department and Equalization.

Commissioner Gross had nothing to report.

Commissioner Majewski had no report

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported that the budget should be about 50% expended; the county is currently 40.08% expensed. Last year at this time $6,913,000.00 was spent and the amount currently expended is $6,927,000.00.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A Grant Township resident shared information regarding Biblical Citizenship classes and the National Day of Prayer, May 7, 2026.

Andrew Goodman, The Hayes Township Zoning Administrator and Code Enforcement, introduced himself to the Board of Commissioners.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to install The National Motto "In God We Trust" in the courthouse and during discussion:

It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to amend Rick's to clarify the location and the specific plaque that will be used which would be the donated plaque from George Gilmore to place it on the front of the lectern in front of the Chairman's position, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Housler, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell and Hoefling
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

The motion was amended and voted on as follows:

It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to install The National Motto "In God We Trust" plaque in the courthouse donated by George Gilmore to be placed on the front/center of the lectern, roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Fancon, Gilmore, Housler, Gross, Haskell and Hoefling
Nays: (0)
Absent: (0)
Motion carried.

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:26 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners